

# Barcode & Scanning — Train-the-Trainer Guide

For Warehouse Managers training Receivers, Packers, and Shipping Clerks on the new GS1-128 / SSCC-based workflow.

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## This guide

Walks a trainer through the material, the hands-on drills, and the sign-off criteria for certifying a new team member on AFB's barcode-based Receiving, Inventory, and Shipping workflow. The full procedures live in SOP-WHS-001 (Receiving), SOP-WHS-002 (Shipping), and SOP-WHS-003 (Inventory) — this document is how you teach them.

## Recommended session plan (½ day)

| # | Segment                                                 | Time   | Goal                                                            |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Why barcodes — FSMA 204, recalls, customer expectations | 20 min | Trainee can explain what a lot recall requires.                 |
| 2 | GS1-128, GTIN, lot, sell-by, SSCC — decoded on paper    | 30 min | Trainee reads a printed label and identifies each AI.           |
| 3 | The hardware — scanner, printer, phone/tablet           | 30 min | Trainee pairs a scanner, prints a label, scans it back.         |
| 4 | Receiving — live drill with 3 mock loads                | 60 min | Trainee logs 3 receipts (good / short / rejected) without help. |
| 5 | Inventory — put-away, cycle count, adjust               | 45 min | Trainee runs a 10-SKU cycle count and reconciles 1 variance.    |
| 6 | Shipping — build pallet, generate SSCC, load            | 60 min | Trainee closes a pallet with SSCC and scans it onto a truck.    |
| 7 | Sign-off, Q&A, refresher-cadence agreement              | 15 min | Trainer signs the certification page.                           |

Total: ~4 hours plus a 15-min break. Do not compress — the drills are the point.

## Module 1 — Why barcodes

### Talk track

- Every case of covered food we handle must, under FDA FSMA 204, be traceable one-up (who we got it from, on what date, with what lot) and one-down (who we shipped it to, on what date, in which pallet).
- The compliance deadline is **July 20, 2028**. We are building the habit and the data now so we are already correct on that date, not scrambling.
- A recall is when everything is on fire. Nobody is reading procedure documents at that moment. The data has to be right *before* it is needed.
- If a receipt is missing a lot code, or a pallet leaves without an SSCC, or a case is scanned onto the wrong order — the trace breaks. A broken trace is a public health risk.

### Check for understanding

- Ask: "If I get a call in 6 hours saying lot LMR-2038 of granola is recalled, what do I need to answer, and how fast?" — good answers name every customer that got that lot and how many cases, in under an hour.
- Ask: "If I skip the lot field on a receipt, what actually breaks?" — the answer should include "we can't trace forward or backward on that case."

## Module 2 — Reading a GS1-128 label

Print two of the sample labels on the next page. Give one to each trainee. Have them find and read out each AI.

| AI   | Meaning              | Length          | Example encoded       | Example decoded         |
|------|----------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| (01) | GTIN — the SKU       | 14 digits       | 01 10614141999996     | GTIN 10614141999996     |
| (10) | Batch / Lot          | up to 20 chars  | 10 LMR2038            | Lot LMR2038             |
| (17) | Expiration (best-by) | 6 digits YYMMDD | 17 260930             | Best by 2026-09-30      |
| (00) | SSCC — pallet ID     | 18 digits       | 00 006141410000012345 | SSCC 006141410000012345 |

### Notes to reinforce

- The parentheses are printed on the label for humans. They are **not** in the barcode itself — the scanner emits *01*, not *(01)*.
- A variable-length AI like (10) is terminated by an invisible *Group Separator* character or by the end of the label. Our decoder handles both.
- Dates are always **YYMMDD**. "261230" is 30 Dec 2026, not 12 Dec 2030.
- If a vendor label has no (01) and no (17), that's OK for internal use — but flag it: FSMA-covered inbound should have both.

## Module 3 — The hardware

| Item             | Model (per Option 2)                                               | Notes for trainer                                                            |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Handheld scanner | Socket Mobile S720 2D (or Zebra CS60-H)                            | Pairs to phone/tablet as a Bluetooth keyboard. Battery lasts a shift; charge |
| Phone / tablet   | BYOD Android/iOS, or shared 8" Android tablet                      | Runs `dashboard`. Keep on Wi-Fi in the warehouse.                            |
| Label printer    | Zebra ZD621 4" thermal transfer                                    | Prints both case labels (4x2) and pallet labels (4x6). Keep two ribbons on h |
| Label media      | Freezer-grade direct thermal for case; thermal transfer for pallet | Freezer-grade adhesive matters — regular adhesive falls off cold cases.      |

### Pairing drill

Do this together on Day 1 — do not skip. Every trainee pairs a scanner to their assigned device with the trainer watching:

- Power on the scanner. It beeps and the pairing LED flashes.
- On the device, open Bluetooth settings, find the scanner ("Socket S720" or "CS60"), tap Pair.
- Open `dashboard` → Receiving → click the barcode field.
- Pull the scanner trigger on the test label. If the digits appear in the field, pairing is complete.
- If the scan appears somewhere else (chat, notes, home screen): the scanner is paired to the wrong device — unpair and redo.

## Module 4 — Receiving drill (3 mock loads)

Set up three mock deliveries at the receiving dock. The trainee logs each without trainer help; the trainer observes and marks the certification checklist.

| Mock load     | What's on it                                        | What the trainee must do                                                              | What they must NOT do                            |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Clean load    | 10 cases, all GS1-128, quantities received          | Scan each case, save with correct put-away, Skip lot or serial, save without location |                                                  |
| Short load    | Case ordered 20 but only 18 arrived, one is damaged | Log quantity received 18, condition = partial damage                                  | Sign, off before flagging to Manager > to def    |
| Rejected load | Off-temperature cold case, seal broken              | Log a receipt with condition = rejected (no inventory increment)                      | Accept it & log, no photograph, wait for Manager |

### Pass criteria

- All three loads logged with 100% of required fields — no blank Received-by, no blank Location, no missing lot on the clean load.
- Rejected load did **not** increment inventory.
- Short-load discrepancy raised to trainer *before* the mock driver "leaves".

## Module 5 — Inventory drill (cycle count + adjust)

Choose one aisle with ~10 SKUs. Print the Inventory Status PDF for it in advance. Introduce a deliberate variance the trainee doesn't know about (e.g. hide 2 units of one SKU).

- Trainee counts each row, marks physical count next to system count.
- Trainee finds the variance and recounts (should recount before assuming the system is wrong).
- Trainee returns to portal, opens the affected SKU, presses Adjust, reason = Manual adjustment, notes "cycle count variance, physical was N".
- Trainer confirms the adjustment reads correctly in the SKU's History.

Pass criteria: trainee recounts before adjusting, uses the correct reason, and writes a note that another human could understand in 6 months.

## Module 6 — Shipping drill (SSCC pallet close)

Use a real order in packed status. Trainee is the Shipping Clerk; trainer plays Forklift Operator and mock driver.

- Trainee creates a Pallet, assigns the order.
- Trainee scans every case onto the pallet — trainer sneaks in one wrong case that must be caught.
- Trainee wraps and corner-protects, then presses Generate SSCC.
- Trainee prints the pallet label, applies two copies (front + side), at 16-32" from the bottom.
- Trainee stages the pallet, then on "truck arrival" scans the SSCC onto the truck manifest, prints the BOL, hands it to the mock driver.

Pass criteria: wrong case was caught during scan (not after wrap); SSCC printed with two labels placed correctly; pallet status ends as **shipped**; truck manifest matches what was scanned.

## Common trainee mistakes — call them out fast

| Mistake                                                  | Why it happens                                                      | Fix in the moment                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skipping lot code on receipt                             | "It's optional, right?" — no, not for FSM/Receivers. It's required. | Reject the receipt and open, enter it.                                       |
| Typing sell-by with wrong century (2126 instead of 2026) | Copy-paste label got garbled                                        | Have them re-read the AI: YYMMDD, two-digit year.                            |
| Loading a case that failed to scan                       | "It's basically the right SKU"                                      | Never. Set it aside, resolve the mismatch, log an adjustment.                |
| Signing the BOL with an unresolved shortage              | Driver pressure                                                     | Not acceptable. If the driver refuses to wait, they leave with the shortage. |
| Batch-entering a shift's worth of receipts all at once   | Trainer too busy"                                                   | The offline paper sheet exists for exactly this. Enter within 4 hours.       |

## Refresh cadence

- **30-day check** — trainer reviews 5 randomly-selected receipts and 5 pallets logged by the trainee. Any recurring gap → 30 min of retraining on the specific step.
- **Quarterly** — 10-minute team huddle on any changes to hardware, media, or the SOPs. Log attendance.
- **Annually** — full re-certification against the three SOPs. Re-sign the certification page below.
- **On any change to scanning hardware or label printers** — a fresh pairing drill for the affected staff.

## Trainee certification

The trainer signs below only when the trainee has passed all six drills with no assist required for pass criteria.

| Field              | Value                                |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Trainee name       |                                      |
| Trainee signature  |                                      |
| Role certified for | ■ Receiver ■ Packer ■ Shipping Clerk |
| Trainer name       |                                      |
| Trainer signature  |                                      |
| Date completed     |                                      |
| Next re-cert due   |                                      |
| Notes              |                                      |

*Filed in: Warehouse Manager's training folder (physical + scanned to shared drive).*